

The Dhāraṇī of the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Twenty-Five Thousand Verses

Āryaprajñāpāramitāpañcaviṃśatisāhasrikādhāraṇī · Toh 577 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རལ་ཏུ་ཕྱུ་བྱེ་པ་སྟོ་ཕག་ཉི་ཤུ་ལྔ་འགྲུབ་ཅུ་སྟེན།

Toh 577 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as the Dhāraṇī of the Perfection of Wisdom in Twenty-Five Thousand Verses, with its Tibetan title rendered as Shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa stong phrag nyi shu lnga pa'i gzungs, and its Sanskrit as Pañcaviṃśatisāhasrikā Prajñāpāramitā Dhāraṇī. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of texts within the Kangyur and takes the form of a concentrated dhāraṇī — a sacred formulaic incantation — that distills and invokes the power of the vast Perfection of Wisdom scripture in twenty-five thousand verses. The text opens with homage to the Blessed Lady, the Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom, and presents a dhāraṇī in Sanskrit syllables calling upon her qualities of wisdom, illumination, and knowledge, promising spiritual attainment to those who hold it. As a dhāraṇī associated with one of the great Prajñāpāramitā sūtras, it sits at the intersection of the wisdom and tantric ritual traditions preserved within the Kangyur.

The dhāraṇī of the Perfection of Wisdom in one hundred thousand verses is complete.

Homage to the Blessed Lady, the Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom.

Thus it is: Oṃ prajñāprajñe, prajñā-avabhāse, prajñā-valokati sarva-dharma andhakāra-bhidhamani, siddhe susiddha, sidhyantu mām bhagavati, sarva-jñānasamghari, bhagavati batsela, prasaradhe hasta mama sukara, siddhi siddhi, buddha buddha, kampa kampa, pāla pāla, dhara dhara, vara vara, garja garja, āgaccha āgaccha bhagavati, mā vilambasva, svāhā.

By holding this, the Perfection of Wisdom —

Translator's Notes

- The passage consists of two distinct parts. The first line is a colophon closing the dhāraṇī associated with the one-hundred-thousand-verse Perfection of Wisdom sūtra. What follows is the opening of a separate dhāraṇī text associated with the twenty-five-thousand-verse Perfection of Wisdom, beginning with homage to the Blessed Lady who is the Mother, Prajñāpāramitā herself, and then the dhāraṇī formula in Sanskrit transliterated into Tibetan script. The final partial phrase indicates the text is cut off mid-sentence, promising the fruit of holding this dhāraṇī. The Sanskrit mantra syllables have been rendered as standard Sanskrit transliteration following the phonetic Tibetan transcription; some syllables are uncertain due to

the imprecision of Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit, particularly "batsela" and "prasaradhe hasta mama sukara," which do not correspond to clearly identifiable Sanskrit words and may represent corrupt or abbreviated forms.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.